

Laopu Gold (6181.HK)

Profit warning: 2Q26 missed with bigger-than-expected sales pressure and operating leverage

6181.HK 12m Price Target: **HK\$560.00** Price: **HK\$396.40** Upside: **41.3%**

What happened: Laopu Gold announced a profit alert on Jul 27, expecting 1H26 revenue to be in a range at Rmb19.8bn-20.5bn (lower than GSe of Rmb21.0bn), while adj. net profit to be in a range of Rmb4.3bn-4.4bn (lower than GSe of Rmb4.8bn). Using mid-point of pre-announced 1Q26 operating results, this implies 2Q26 net profit range of Rmb0.56bn-0.61bn (or Rmb0.66bn-0.71bn if using lower-end for 1Q26), 40%-45% lower than GSe of Rmb1.0bn.

GS view: We expect to see negative share price reaction post the announcement, with 2Q26 sales and margin below market expectation. Using the mid-point of 1Q26 results announced earlier (i.e. reported revenue of Rmb16.5bn-17.5bn, net profit of Rmb3.6bn-3.8bn), the implied revenue in 2Q26 is at Rmb2.8bn-Rmb3.5bn (vs. GSe implied revenue 4.0bn), and implied net profit in 2Q26 is at Rmb0.56bn-Rmb0.61bn (vs. GSe implied net profit Rmb1.0bn); the implied net profit margin in 2Q26 is at 19% at the mid-point, which we view is lower than expectation considering the GPM expansion post price hike (according to management's comment in May, GPM is able to reach >45% post price hike) and rental cost is largely variable, presumably due to 1) operating leverage in staff and marketing/G&A expenses considering the company's investment in store upgrade and branding, 2) lower online sales (our online tracker suggests >60% yoy decline in Tmall in 2Q26) which is a margin accretive channel.

That said, we note the company has been testing and rolling out lower price amid gold price pull back (more details [here](#)) — following the initial test in Shanghai Xintiandi store, Laopu also allowed stack of membership discount and promotion discount (i.e. 5% more off than prior) in SKP recently, which brought notable improvement in traffic.

We lower Laopu's 2026-28E net profit forecast by 14%-15%, reflecting: 1) lowered sales expectation with bigger-than-expected

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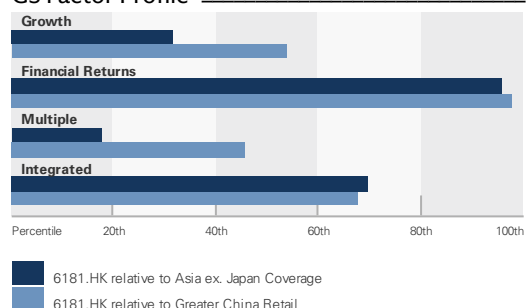
Key Data

Market cap: HK\$68.4bn / \$8.7bn
Enterprise value: HK\$67.0bn / \$8.5bn
3m ADTV: HK\$530.3mn / \$67.7mn
China
Greater China Retail
M&A Rank: 3
Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: Yes

GS Forecast

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Revenue (Rmb mn) New	27,303.2	32,188.2	31,909.6	34,957.5
Revenue (Rmb mn) Old	27,303.2	33,976.6	33,693.7	36,916.5
EBITDA (Rmb mn)	6,888.6	9,478.1	9,755.0	10,450.0
EPS (Rmb) New	28.25	38.38	39.41	41.77
EPS (Rmb) Old	28.25	45.15	45.96	48.30
P/E (X)	22.5	8.9	8.7	8.2
P/B (X)	10.1	4.2	3.7	3.3
Dividend yield (%)	3.4	8.4	8.6	9.1
CROCI (%)	53.7	48.3	52.9	54.8
	6/25	12/25	6/26E	12/26E
EPS (Rmb)	13.31	14.89	24.28	14.10

GS Factor Profile



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.
See disclosures for details.

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BUY

Laopu Gold (6181.HK)

Rating since Oct 7, 2024

Ratios & Valuation

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
P/E (X)	22.5	8.9	8.7	8.2
P/B (X)	10.1	4.2	3.7	3.3
FCF yield (%)	(6.8)	15.9	12.2	11.1
EV/EBITDAR (X)	16.5	6.2	5.8	5.3
EV/EBITDA (excl. leases) (X)	17.1	6.4	6.0	5.4
CROCI (%)	53.7	48.3	52.9	54.8
ROE (%)	64.8	53.5	45.8	42.8
Net debt/equity (%)	41.4	(8.5)	(21.4)	(27.1)
Net debt/equity (excl. leases) (%)	37.8	(11.7)	(24.5)	(30.1)
Interest cover (X)	52.9	108.8	139.2	59.5
Days inventory outst, sales	134.6	159.3	132.9	121.1
Receivable days	13.9	13.9	15.7	15.7
Days payable outstanding	9.3	10.9	9.4	8.8
DuPont ROE (%)	43.9	47.6	43.1	40.3
Turnover (X)	1.3	1.5	1.4	1.4
Leverage (X)	1.9	1.5	1.4	1.3
Gross cash invested (ex cash) (Rmb)	16,379.4	14,094.9	14,211.0	15,394.1
Average capital employed (Rmb)	9,926.2	13,928.6	12,369.9	12,485.4
BVPS (Rmb)	62.90	80.65	91.39	103.72

Growth & Margins (%)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Total revenue growth	221.0	17.9	(0.9)	9.6
EBITDA growth	219.7	37.6	2.9	7.1
EPS growth	198.3	35.9	2.7	6.0
DPS growth	213.1	33.6	2.7	6.0
EBIT margin	24.0	28.2	29.1	28.4
EBITDA margin	25.2	29.4	30.6	29.9
Net income margin	17.8	21.0	21.8	21.1

Price Performance

Source: FactSet. Price as of 27 Jul 2026 close.

Income Statement (Rmb mn)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Total revenue	27,303.2	32,188.2	31,909.6	34,957.5
Cost of goods sold	(17,029.5)	(18,528.4)	(18,044.1)	(20,010.0)
SG&A	(3,699.4)	(4,551.9)	(4,539.8)	(4,977.8)
R&D	(24.9)	(27.7)	(31.0)	(32.4)
Other operating inc./exp.)	—	—	—	—
EBITDA	6,888.6	9,478.1	9,755.0	10,450.0
Depreciation & amortization	(339.2)	(398.0)	(460.3)	(512.7)
EBIT	6,549.4	9,080.1	9,294.6	9,937.4
Net interest inc./exp.)	(135.2)	(82.0)	(29.7)	(117.0)
Income/(loss) from associates	—	—	—	—
Pre-tax profit	6,384.0	9,002.0	9,268.8	9,824.2
Provision for taxes	(1,516.0)	(2,232.5)	(2,317.2)	(2,456.1)
Minority interest	—	—	—	—
Preferred dividends	—	—	—	—
Net inc. (pre-exceptionals)	4,867.9	6,769.5	6,951.6	7,368.2
Post-tax exceptionals	—	—	—	—
Net inc. (post-exceptionals)	4,867.9	6,769.5	6,951.6	7,368.2
EPS (basic, pre-exception) (Rmb)	28.35	38.38	39.41	41.77
EPS (diluted, pre-exception) (Rmb)	28.25	38.38	39.41	41.77
EPS (basic, post-exception) (Rmb)	28.35	38.38	39.41	41.77
EPS (diluted, post-exception) (Rmb)	28.25	38.38	39.41	41.77
DPS (Rmb)	21.54	28.78	29.56	31.33
Div. payout ratio (%)	76.0	75.0	75.0	75.0

Balance Sheet (Rmb mn)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Cash & cash equivalents	2,068.1	5,823.8	7,277.3	8,829.1
Accounts receivable	1,280.2	1,173.6	1,578.1	1,436.5
Inventory	16,044.4	12,043.5	11,187.4	12,006.0
Other current assets	1,156.7	1,258.5	1,225.6	1,359.1
Total current assets	20,549.5	20,299.4	21,268.4	23,630.7
Net PP&E	561.6	684.2	780.2	846.3
Net intangibles	12.9	12.9	12.9	12.9
Total investments	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Other long-term assets	128.6	128.6	128.6	128.6
Total assets	21,252.5	21,125.2	22,190.1	24,618.5
Accounts payable	635.9	470.1	457.8	507.7
Short-term debt	6,164.2	4,164.2	3,331.3	3,331.3
Short-term lease liabilities	228.1	248.0	274.4	300.8
Other current liabilities	2,852.0	1,817.3	1,785.2	1,941.6
Total current liabilities	9,880.2	6,699.6	5,848.8	6,081.4
Long-term debt	100.1	—	—	—
Long-term lease liabilities	172.4	200.1	221.4	242.6
Other long-term liabilities	4.7	—	—	—
Total long-term liabilities	277.2	200.1	221.4	242.6
Total liabilities	10,157.4	6,899.7	6,070.2	6,324.0
Preferred shares	—	—	—	—
Total common equity	11,095.1	14,225.5	16,120.0	18,294.4
Minority interest	—	—	—	—
Total liabilities & equity	21,252.5	21,125.2	22,190.1	24,618.5
Net debt, adjusted	4,196.2	(1,659.6)	(3,946.0)	(5,497.7)

Cash Flow (Rmb mn)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Net income	6,384.0	9,002.0	9,268.8	9,824.2
D&A add-back	339.2	398.0	460.3	512.7
Minority interest add-back	—	—	—	—
Net (inc)/dec working capital	(12,552.4)	2,805.2	440.2	(604.3)
Other operating cash flow	(1,019.0)	(2,095.2)	(2,267.5)	(2,319.0)
Cash flow from operations	(6,848.2)	10,110.0	7,901.9	7,413.6
Capital expenditures	(145.1)	(162.6)	(185.1)	(180.1)
Acquisitions	—	—	—	—
Divestitures	—	—	—	—
Others	0.0	(38.0)	(38.0)	(38.0)
Cash flow from investing	(145.1)	(200.7)	(223.2)	(218.2)
Repayment of lease liabilities	(387.6)	(373.6)	(372.0)	(501.3)
Dividends paid (common & pref)	(1,096.5)	(3,699.2)	(5,077.1)	(5,213.7)
Inc/(dec) in debt	4,893.5	(2,100.1)	(832.8)	—
Other financing cash flows	4,769.4	19.2	56.7	71.3
Cash flow from financing	8,210.8	(6,153.6)	(6,225.2)	(5,643.7)
Total cash flow	1,217.5	3,755.7	1,453.5	1,551.7
Free cash flow	(7,380.9)	9,573.8	7,344.8	6,732.2

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.

sales pressure amid gold price pull back reflected in 2Q26 miss, and resulted operating deleverage, 2) lowered GPM forecast for 2H26 with company further rolling out price actions, to support sales performance. That said, if gold price normalizes/picks up (GS looks for US\$4,900 at year end vs. ~US\$4,100 currently), we would expect the worst backdrop for sales to be behind us, with gradual consumption sentiment recovery post price hikes, digestion of reseller inventory, and new product launches (including lowered prices) stimulating customer demand. We cut our TP to HK\$560 (from HK\$650 prior) implying 41% upside, remain Buy rated.

We expect Laopu will report a full set of results in late Aug (last year: Aug 20). Into results, we think the focus should be on: 1) sales expectation into 2H26 and ahead, and sequential sales trend; 2) margin outlook, including GPM adjustment and OPEX ratio; 3) management's strategy and adjustment in face of the weaker gold price; 4) pricing strategy and how to balance brand positioning vs. sales; 5) thoughts on shareholder return and share buyback; 6) progress of VIC system development and gold ornament.

Exhibit 1: Laopu's 2Q26 results were below GSe in both sales and margin

1H26E (RMB bn)	GSe		Actual			Mid-point Actual		
	GSe	yoy%	Actual	yoy%	vs. GSe	Actual	yoy%	vs. GSe
Sales	21.0	70%	19.8~20.5	60%~66%	-6%~-3%	20.1	63%	-4%
NP	4.7	109%	4.29~4.34	88%~90%	-10%~-9%	4.3	89%	-10%
NPM	22.6%	4.2ppt	21.2~21.6	2.7~3.1pp	-1.5~-1.1pp	21.3%	3.5ppt	-1.3ppt
Adj. NP	4.8	103%	4.3~4.4	83%~85%	-10%~-9%	4.3	84%	-9%
Adj. NPM	22.7%	3.6ppt	21.3~21.8%	2.3~2.7pp	-1.4~-0.9pp	21.5%	2.5ppt	-1.1ppt
2Q26E (RMB bn)	GSe	yoy%	Actual	yoy%	vs. GSe	Actual	yoy%	vs. GSe
Sales	4.0		2.8~3.5		-30%~-14%	3.1		-22%
NP	1.0		0.56~0.61		-46%~-42%	0.6		-44%
NPM	26.0%		17.7~20%		-8.3~-6.0pp	18.7%		-7.2ppt
Adj. NP	1.0		0.56~0.61		-45%~-40%	0.6		-43%
Adj. NPM	25.3%		17.7~20%		-7.7~-5.3pp	18.7%		-6.6ppt

Implied 2Q26 number is calculated based on mid-point of pre-announced 1Q26 results. Assume Rmb40mn/0mn ESOP in 1Q26/2Q26.

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: Laopu Gold earnings revision

RMB mn Accounting standards: HKFRS	Dec-26 2026E			Dec-27 2027E			Dec-28 2028E		
Income statement	New	Old	Var	New	Old	Var	New	Old	Var
Revenue	32,188	33,977	-5.3%	31,910	33,694	-5.3%	34,958	36,917	-5.3%
ML China	26,472	27,946	-5.3%	24,632	26,014	-5.3%	26,211	27,687	-5.3%
HK&Macau and overseas	5,716	6,031	-5.2%	7,278	7,680	-5.2%	8,747	9,229	-5.2%
Cost of sales	(18,528)	(18,807)	-1.5%	(18,044)	(18,309)	-1.4%	(20,010)	(20,427)	-2.0%
Gross profit	13,660	15,169	-10.0%	13,865	15,385	-9.9%	14,948	16,490	-9.4%
SG&A	(4,580)	(4,502)	1.7%	(4,571)	(4,558)	0.3%	(5,010)	(5,030)	-0.4%
Selling and distribution expense	(3,903)	(3,888)	0.4%	(3,873)	(3,920)	-1.2%	(4,274)	(4,358)	-1.9%
General and administrative expense	(649)	(587)	10.6%	(666)	(607)	9.7%	(704)	(640)	10.0%
R&D expense	(28)	(28)	0.0%	(31)	(31)	0.0%	(32)	(32)	0.0%
Operating profit (loss)	9,080	10,668	-14.9%	9,295	10,827	-14.1%	9,937	11,459	-13.3%
Net interest income/(expense)	(82)	(82)	0.0%	(30)	(21)	41.2%	(117)	(104)	12.1%
Other income (excl. interest income)	4	4	0.0%	4	4	0.0%	4	4	0.0%
Other expense, net	-	-	n.m.	-	-	n.m.	-	-	n.m.
Profit before tax	9,002	10,589	-15.0%	9,269	10,809	-14.3%	9,824	11,359	-13.5%
Income tax benefit (expense)	(2,233)	(2,626)	-15.0%	(2,317)	(2,702)	-14.3%	(2,456)	(2,840)	-13.5%
Minority interests	-	-	n.m.	-	-	n.m.	-	-	n.m.
NI attributed to equity shareholders	6,770	7,963	-15.0%	6,952	8,107	-14.3%	7,368	8,519	-13.5%
Adj NI	6,830	8,013	-14.8%	6,972	8,127	-14.2%	7,388	8,539	-13.5%
Dividend announced	5,077	5,972	-15.0%	5,214	6,080	-14.3%	5,526	6,389	-13.5%
Margin / % Of Company Sales									
GP margin	42.4%	44.6%	-2.2%	43.5%	45.7%	-2.2%	42.8%	44.7%	-1.9%
OP margin	28.2%	31.4%	-3.2%	29.1%	32.1%	-3.0%	28.4%	31.0%	-2.6%
Net margin	21.0%	23.4%	-2.4%	21.8%	24.1%	-2.3%	21.1%	23.1%	-2.0%
Adj NPM	21.2%	23.6%	-2.4%	21.8%	24.1%	-2.3%	21.1%	23.1%	-2.0%
SG&A expense	14.2%	13.2%	1.0%	14.3%	13.5%	0.8%	14.3%	13.6%	0.7%
Selling and distribution expense	12.1%	11.4%	0.7%	12.1%	11.6%	0.5%	12.2%	11.8%	0.4%
General and administrative expense	2.0%	1.7%	0.3%	2.1%	1.8%	0.3%	2.0%	1.7%	0.3%
R&D expense	0.1%	0.1%	0.0%	0.1%	0.1%	0.0%	0.1%	0.1%	0.0%
Effective Tax Rate	24.8%	24.8%	0.0%	25.0%	25.0%	0.0%	25.0%	25.0%	0.0%
Dividend payout	75.0%	75.0%	0.0%	75.0%	75.0%	0.0%	75.0%	75.0%	0.0%
Operation metrics									
Number of boutiques	49	49	0%	55	55	0%	59	58	2%
ML China	40	40	0%	42	42	0%	44	43	2%
HK&Macau and overseas	9	9	0%	13	13	0%	15	15	0%
SSSG	0%	8%	-8%	-10%	-10%	0%	2%	3%	-1%
ML China	0%	8%	-8%	-10%	-10%	0%	2%	3%	-1%
HK&Macau and overseas	0%	8%	-8%	-10%	-10%	0%	2%	3%	-1%
Store productivity									
ML China	538	575	-7%	486	520	-7%	495	785	-37%
HK&Macau and overseas	762	804	-5%	662	698	-5%	625	898	-30%

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Laopu Gold

We derive our 12-m TP of HK\$560 for Laopu Gold on a 13x 2026E target P/E. Key risks include: 1) potential gold price slump, 2) tough regulatory environment for luxury consumption, 3) regional concentration, and 4) overhang of IPO shares post lock-up expiry.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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Growth is based on a stock's forward-looking sales growth, EBITDA growth and EPS growth (for financial stocks, only EPS and sales growth), with a higher percentile indicating a higher growth company. **Financial Returns** is based on a stock's forward-looking ROE, ROCE and CROCI (for financial stocks, only ROE), with a higher percentile indicating a company with higher financial returns. **Multiple** is based on a stock's forward-looking P/E, P/B, price/dividend (P/D), EV/EBITDA, EV/FCF and EV/Debt Adjusted Cash Flow (DACF) (for financial stocks, only P/E, P/B and P/D), with a higher percentile indicating a stock trading at a higher multiple. The **Integrated** percentile is calculated as the average of the Growth percentile, Financial Returns percentile and (100% - Multiple percentile).

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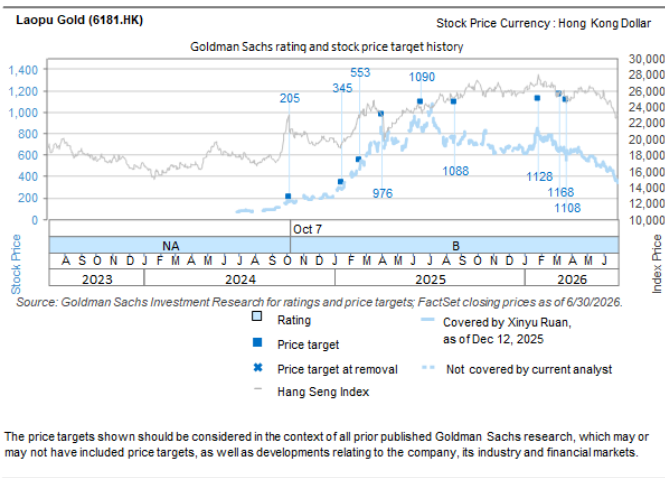
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	Buy	Hold	Sell	Buy	Hold	Sell
Global	50%	34%	16%	65%	59%	43%

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Price target and rating history chart(s)



Target price history table(s)

Laopu Gold (6181.HK)

Date of report	Target price (HK\$)	Closing price (HK\$)
10-Jul-26	650.00	391.20
24-Mar-26	1,108.00	648.50
11-Mar-26	1,168.00	654.00
29-Jan-26	1,128.00	787.50
21-Aug-25	1,088.00	751.00
17-Jun-25	1,090.00	881.50
03-Apr-25	976.00	800.00
20-Feb-25	553.00	468.40
15-Jan-25	345.00	281.00
07-Oct-24	205.00	175.00

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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